

Beiduo Chen

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EDUCATION

Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München

Munich, Germany

Ph.D. in Natural Language Processing at MaiNLP Lab, supervised by Prof. Barbara Plank (ACL President)

2024 - June 2027 (expected)

Topic: LLM Evaluation, Trustworthiness, Human-Centered NLP, Uncertainty, and Chain-of-Thought Reasoning

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

Exchange ELLIS Ph.D. Student at Language Technology Lab, supervised by Prof. Anna Korhonen

2025

University of Science and Technology of China

Anhui, China

Master of Engineering in Information and Communication Engineering, supervised by Prof. Wu Guo

2020 - 2023

Thesis: A Study on Multilingual Representation Learning and Application based on Pre-trained Language Model

GPA: 3.93/4.3, top 1%

University of Science and Technology of China

Anhui, China

Bachelor of Engineering in Electronic and Information Engineering, supervised by Prof. Wu Guo

2016 - 2020

Thesis: Speaker Recognition based on Depth Features

GPA: 3.75/4.3, top 3%

EXPERIENCE (CURRENTLY OPEN AND FLEXIBLE FOR INTERNSHIPS)

Microsoft Research Asia

Beijing, China

Research intern, hosted by Shaohan Huang

Jun 2022 - Jan 2023

Topic: Language Model Pre-training

iFLYTEK Research

Anhui, China

Research intern, hosted by Quan Liu

Jun 2021 - Mar 2022

Topic: Multilingualism; Cross-lingual Transfer; Named Entity Recognition

PUBLICATIONS (*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION.)

- **Beiduo Chen**, Pingjun Hong, Ziyun Zhang, Benjamin Roth, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. Human Label Variation as Stable Signal: Learning Annotator-Specific Explanation Behavior via Cross-Annotator Preference Optimization. *Preprint*. 2026.
- Xinyuan Cheng*, **Beiduo Chen***, Philipp Mondorf, Barbara Plank. Reasoning that Travels: Dissecting How Chain-of-Thought Transfers Across Models. *Preprint*. 2026.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Tiancheng Hu, Caiqi Zhang, Robert Litschko, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. Decoupling the Effect of Chain-of-Thought Reasoning: A Human Label Variation Perspective. *Findings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. 2026.
- Pingjun Hong*, **Beiduo Chen***, Siyao Peng, Marie-Catherine de Marneffe, Benjamin Roth, Barbara Plank. Agree, Disagree, Explain: Decomposing Human Label Variation in NLI through the Lens of Explanations. *Findings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. 2026.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Yang Janet Liu, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. Threading the Needle: Reweaving Chain-of-Thought Reasoning to Explain Human Label Variation. *The 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. 2025.
Oral Presentation.
- Pingjun Hong*, **Beiduo Chen***, Siyao Peng, Marie-Catherine de Marneffe, Barbara Plank. LiTE_x: A Linguistic Taxonomy of Explanations for Understanding Within-Label Variation in Natural Language Inference. *The 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. 2025. SAC Highlights Award.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Siyao Peng, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. A Rose by Any Other Name: LLM-Generated Explanations Are Good Proxies for Human Explanations to Collect Label Distributions on NLI. *Findings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. 2025.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Xinpeng Wang, Siyao Peng, Robert Litschko, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. "Seeing the Big through the Small": Can LLMs Approximate Human Judgment Distributions on NLI from a Few Explanations? *Findings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. 2024.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Shaohan Huang, Zihan Zhang, Wu Guo, Zhenhua Ling, Haizhen Huang, Furu Wei, Weiwei Deng and Qi Zhang. Pre-training Language Model as a Multi-perspective Course Learner. *Findings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. 2023.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Wu Guo, Bin Gu, Quan Liu, Yongchao Wang. Multi-Level Contrastive Learning for Cross-Lingual Alignment. *2022 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2022.

- Jun-Yu Ma^{*}, **Beiduo Chen**^{*}, Jia-Chen Gu, Zhenhua Ling, Wu Guo, Quan Liu, Zhigang Chen and Cong Liu. Wider & Closer: Mixture of Short-channel Distillers for Zero-shot Cross-lingual Named Entity Recognition. *The 2022 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. 2022.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Wu Guo, Quan Liu, Kun Tao. Feature Aggregation in Zero-Shot Cross-Lingual Transfer Using Multilingual BERT. *The 26th International Conference on Pattern Recognition (ICPR)*. 2022.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Jun-Yu Ma, Jiajun Qi, Wu Guo, Zhen-Hua Ling, Quan Liu. USTC-NELSLIP at SemEval-2022 Task 11: Gazetteer-Adapted Integration Network for Multilingual Complex Named Entity Recognition. *The 16th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval) at 2022 Annual Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL)*. 2022.
- Raoyuan Zhao, **Beiduo Chen**, Barbara Plank, Michael A. Hedderich. MAKIEval: A Multilingual Automatic WiKidata-based Framework for Cultural Awareness Evaluation for LLMs. *Findings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. 2025.
- **Beiduo Chen**, Pingjun Hong, Ziyun Zhang, Benjamin Roth, Anna Korhonen, Barbara Plank. Human Label Variation as Stable Signal: Learning Annotator-Specific Explanation Behavior via Cross-Annotator Preference Optimization. *Under Peer Review*. 2026.
- Xinyuan Cheng^{*}, **Beiduo Chen**^{*}, Philipp Mondorf, Barbara Plank. Reasoning that Travels: Dissecting How Chain-of-Thought Transfers Across Models. *Under Peer Review*. 2026.
- Benedetta Muscato, **Beiduo Chen**, Gizem Gezici, Siyao Peng, Barbara Plank, Fosca Giannotti. Disagreeing Rationales: Rethinking Classification and Explainability Evaluation in Hate Speech Detection. *Under Peer Review*. 2026.

SHARED TASKS

- 2022, Rank 1st on three tracks (Chinese, Code-mixed and Bangla), and rank 2nd on the other ten tracks in the 16th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2022) Task 11 Multilingual Complex Named Entity Recognition, as the first author.

PATENT

- **Beiduo Chen**, Qingqing Huang, Jun Du. Multi-Feature Fusion Method for Neural Machine Translation Error Detection Based on Data Enhancement Training. Patent of China National Intellectual Property Administration (CNIPA). 2021.

TALKS

- Invited Panel Discussion, 4th Workshop on Perspectivist Approaches to NLP (NLPerspectives) at EMNLP 2025, Suzhou, China. November 8th, 2025. (Panelist)
- Invited Talk, Dealing with Meaning Variation in NLP - 3rd Yearly Workshop at Utrecht University, Netherlands. *Explanations as a Catalyst: Leveraging Large Language Models to Embrace Human Label Variation*. October 28th, 2025.
- Invited Talk, Language Technology Lab Seminars at University of Cambridge, United Kingdom. *Explanations as a Catalyst: Leveraging Large Language Models to Embrace Human Label Variation*. October 10th, 2025.
- Invited Talk, 4th International Workshop on Dependability Modeling and Digitalization (WDMD) at The 55th Annual IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (DSN 2025) in Naples, Italy. *Understanding and Modeling Human Label Variation in LLM*. June 25th, 2025.

HONORS

- 2025, Senior Area Chair Highlights Award at EMNLP 2025 (1% acceptance).
- 2025, Mobility Grant of European Lighthouse on Secure and Safe AI (ELSA).
- 2024, European Laboratory for Learning and Intelligent Systems (ELLIS) Ph.D. Program (5% acceptance).
- 2023, Outstanding Graduate Award of University of Science and Technology of China.
- 2023, Outstanding Graduate Award of Ordinary Colleges and Universities in Anhui Province.
- 2022, China National Scholarship.
- 2020, Suzhou Yucai Scholarship: Top 1 GPA in the class (1/120).
- 2019, Scholarship of the Institute of Electronics, Chinese Academy of Sciences.
- 2018, The third prize (provincial) in Contemporary Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling of China.
- 2017, Gold Award for Outstanding Student of USTC.

SERVICE

- Program Committee/Reviewer: TPAMI, ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, ACL Rolling Review, COLM, ICASSP, ICPR, NLPOR@COLM2025.

TEACHING

- Lecture: Information Retrieval (SS2025; SS2026, LMU Munich, 2025; 2026), LLM Agents (SS2025, LMU Munich, 2025), Symbolic Programming Language (WS2024/25; WS2025/26, LMU Munich, 2024; 2025), Multi-modal NLP (SS2024, LMU Munich, 2024). Signals and Systems (210049, 210049.05, USTC, 2021), Computer Programming A (CS1001A, 210522.02, USTC, 2019), Electromagnetism C (PHYS1004C, 022503.03, USTC, 2018).
- Seminar: Explaining and Interpreting Annotations in NLP (WS2025/26, LMU Munich, 2025), Discourse Modeling and Processing (WS2024/25, LMU Munich, 2024), NLP for Climate Change (SS2024, LMU Munich, 2024).

MENTORSHIP

- 2026, Xinyuan Cheng, MSc Thesis on LLM Reasoning. *Measuring the Quality of Chain-of-Thought in Reasoning-Tuned Large Language Models via Cross-Model Utility*.
- 2026, Liuhui Zhu, MSc Thesis on LLM Agents. *Beyond Majority Vote: Structured Aggregation of Reasoning Trajectories in Multi-Agent LLM Debate*.
- 2025, Pingjun Hong, MSc Thesis on Within-label Variation. *Within-Label Variation in Natural Language Inference: A Linguistic Taxonomy for Explanations and Its Impact on Model Interpretation of Label Decisions*.
- 2024, Vu Thanh Trung Bui, BSc Thesis on Multilingual LLM. *Exploring Multilingual Capabilities in Large Language Models with Soft Prompt Tuning*.

SKILLS

- Languages: Python (proficient), HTML, C/C++ (academic project level), Matlab (academic project level)
- Frameworks: PyTorch, TensorFlow, HuggingFace, vLLM, DeepSpeed, Transformers, Keras, Scikit-Learn, Jupyter, CUDA